

Field CHA-016

96 acres in Champaign County, Illinois. What the satellite record shows for the 2026 season.

Prepared Oct 6, 2026
Imagery through Oct 2, 2026
Field Record (working name)



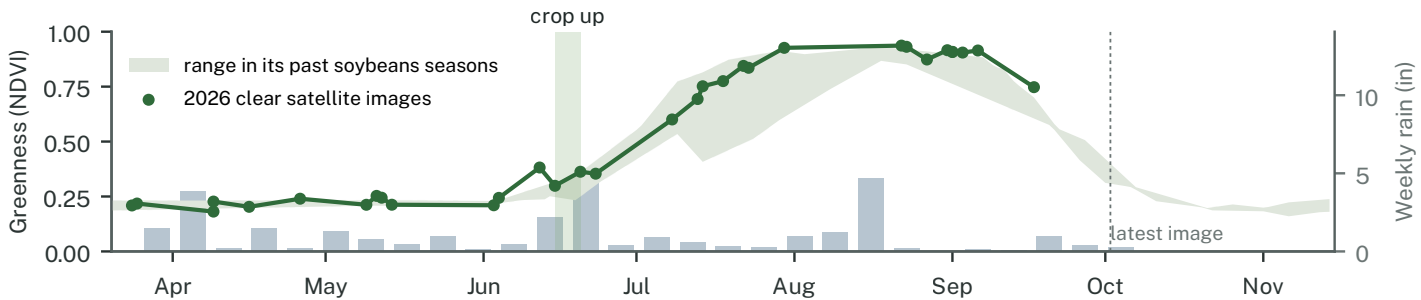
USDA NAIP aerial photo, 2023. Field boundary in yellow; numbered areas match the list below.

2026 crop	Soybeans (high confidence)
Crop came up	between Jun 15 and Jun 20, so likely planted Jun 1 to Jun 13
Harvest	crop still green in the last clear image (Sep 17)
After the 2025 harvest	Tilled (fall); residue dropped between Nov 5, 2025 and Nov 17, 2025
Winter 2025-26	No cover crop seen (8 clear winter images, all bare)
Season greenness	2nd greenest of its 4 soybeans seasons since 2020; 15th percentile of 1,753 Champaign County soybeans fields

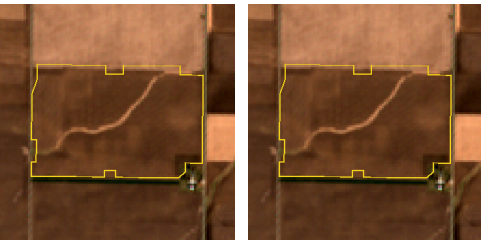
2019 Corn	2020 Soybeans	2021 Corn	2022 Soybeans	2023 Corn	2024 Soybeans	2025 Corn	2026 Soybeans
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Crop by year: USDA Cropland Data Layer 2019-2025; 2026 from our model.

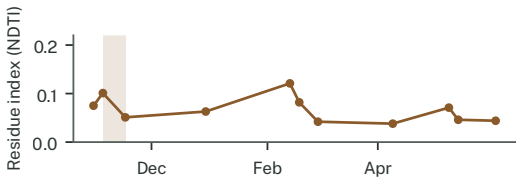
The 2026 season



After the 2025 harvest



Nov 5, 2025, Sentinel-2 (before) Nov 5, 2025, Sentinel-2 (after)



Worth a look

- 3.1 acres that stay less green than the rest of the field in mid-summer (2023, 2024, 2026). Often drainage, compaction or a wet spot; worth walking.
- 2.0 acres that stay less green than the rest of the field in mid-summer (2023, 2025). Often drainage, compaction or a wet spot; worth walking.
- 5.8 acres ran about 2.3 °C warmer than the rest of the field in July-August 2026, a common sign of crop stress.

This field is in soybeans for 2026, and the crop was up by Jun 20. Harvest has not shown up in the imagery yet; the latest clear image is from Sep 17. Through the summer it stayed behind most soybeans fields in the county (15th percentile on greenness), which tracks crop vigor but is not a yield estimate. There are 3 areas worth a look on the next visit, marked on the aerial photo; the imagery shows where, not why.

Evidence. Dates above rest on these satellite scenes: Nov 5 2025, tillage (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Nov 17 2025, tillage (S2A T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 15 2026, crop up (S2A T16TDK orbit 126); Jun 20 2026, crop up (Landsat 8 path/row 023032); Aug 22 2026, peak (S2C T16TDK orbit 126); Sep 17 2026, dry-down, harvest (Landsat 8 path/row 022032). The chart and winter checks use 76 clear images from Aug 2025 on, all listed in the field record file.

How it was made. Greenness is NDVI and the residue index is NDTI, averaged 10 m inside the boundary (USDA NASS Crop Sequence Boundaries). Crop up is when greenness first passed 0.30; planting is estimated 1-2 weeks earlier. Hot spots use Landsat 8/9 surface temperature. Season greenness tracks crop vigor and is not a yield estimate.